

Kansas Driver's Test - Study Guide

A complete, plain-English summary of the entire Kansas Driving Handbook (AAMVA / Feb 2022), condensed for studying. Practice tests and the answer key are separate files.

The knowledge test: 25 multiple-choice questions on traffic laws, signs, and pavement markings. **To pass:** 80% - 20 of 25 correct. Not timed (~15-20 min). Can be taken at a license office or online at ks.knowtodrive.com. **Retakes:** 4 attempts allowed; after the 4th fail you must wait 6 months (\$1.50 re-test fee). **Vision:** Must be at least 20/40 in one eye (glasses/contacts OK).

THE 1-PAGE CHEAT SHEET (memorize these first)

Topic	The number / answer
Pass the test	80% (20 of 25)
Drunk driving (adult)	Illegal at .08 BAC or higher
Under 21 drinking + driving	Zero tolerance - any alcohol is illegal (impaired at .02)
City / urban speed limit	30 mph
State or Federal highway	65 mph
County / township road	55 mph
Multilane separated highway	75 mph (if posted)
School zone / business district	20 mph (when marked/flashing)
Following distance (normal)	2-second rule
Following distance (bad weather / motorcycle)	3-4 seconds
Signal before a turn (city)	100 feet ahead (200 ft above 40 mph)
No parking near a fire hydrant	within 15 feet
Stay back from emergency vehicle	500 feet
Vision requirement	20/40
License expires	On your birthday
Yield to pedestrians	Always - even jaywalkers
4-way stop tie	Car on the right goes

1. LICENSE, PERMITS & THE LAW

- A Kansas license is required to drive on public roads; you must get one **within 90 days** of moving to Kansas.

- **Driving is a privilege, not a right** - it can be suspended or revoked.
- **Class C license** = passenger vehicles **under 26,001 lbs.**

Graduated Driver's Licensing (GDL) - teen stages:

- **Instruction Permit (14+)**: Drive **only** with a licensed adult **21+** (with 1+ years' experience) in the **front seat**. No wireless device use. No other person but the adult in the front seat.
- **Restricted License (15)**: Held learner's permit 1 year; limited driving (to/from school, work, religious activities); no non-sibling minor passengers; supervised by a licensed adult.
- **Less-restricted (16)**: May drive 5 a.m.-9 p.m. and to school/work/religious activities; only **one** non-sibling minor passenger.
- **Unrestricted (17)**: All age-related restrictions removed (after holding restricted license 6 months past age 16).

Losing your license:

- **3 moving violations within 12 months** -> suspension.
- Refusing a chemical (BAC) test -> **1-year** suspension (1st refusal; longer for repeats).
- DUI, no insurance, failure to appear, leaving an accident -> suspension/revocation.

Documents to bring (general): proof of identity/lawful presence (List A/B), Social Security proof, and **two** proofs of Kansas residency. **Real ID** (for flights/federal buildings after May 3, 2023) requires originals (not laminated/photocopied).

Organ donor: Anyone **18+** can register as a donor on their license (first-person consent - legally binding). Under 18 needs a parent's signature.

2. SIGNS - Know the SHAPE and COLOR

The test shows signs by shape, color, or symbol - sometimes with no words. Color and shape alone tell you the type.

Shapes

Shape	Always means
Octagon (8 sides)	STOP - only sign with 8 sides
Triangle (point down)	YIELD - only sign this shape
Pennant (sideways triangle, on left)	NO PASSING ZONE - only pennant sign
Diamond	Warning - hazard ahead
Pentagon (5 sides, point up)	School zone / school crossing
Round	Railroad crossing ahead (yellow circle, "RR" + X)
Crossbuck (white X)	Railroad crossing - at the tracks
Rectangle / square	Regulatory rule, guide, or service info

Colors

Color	Means
Red	Stop or prohibition (Stop, Yield, Wrong Way, Do Not Enter)
Yellow	General warning (curve, hill, intersection ahead)
Orange	Work zone / construction
Fluorescent yellow-green	School, pedestrian, bicycle crossing
Fluorescent pink	Incident (crash, hazmat, emergency detour)
White (black text)	Regulatory - a law you must obey (Speed Limit)
Green	Guide - directions, distances, exits
Blue	Services - gas, food, lodging, hospital, phone
Brown	Recreation - parks, historical sites

 Red circle with a slash = that action is **prohibited** (No Left Turn, No U-Turn).

Specific signs worth memorizing

- **No Turn on Red** -> may NOT turn on red; wait for green.
- **Stop Here on Red** -> stop at this line on red (right turn still allowed after stopping).
- **Do Not Enter** (white bar in red circle) -> wrong way / don't enter.
- **Wrong Way** -> you're going the wrong direction; turn around.
- **Keep Right / Slower Traffic Keep Right** -> stay right unless passing.
- **Shared Center Lane (Left Turn Only)** -> middle lane for left turns from both directions only - never through traffic or passing.
- **Slow-Moving Vehicle** (orange/red triangle) -> vehicle going **under 25 mph** (farm equipment, buggies).
- **Route markers**: shield shape/color shows interstate, U.S., or state route.
- **Exit signs**: "Exit" on the **left** of the sign = exit is on the left; on the **right** = exit on the right.

3. TRAFFIC SIGNALS (lights)

Light	What to do
Steady GREEN	Go if clear. Yield to pedestrians & oncoming traffic when turning left.
GREEN ARROW	Protected turn - oncoming traffic is stopped.
Steady YELLOW	Light is about to turn red. Stop if you safely can.
Flashing YELLOW	Slow down, proceed with caution .
Steady RED	Stop behind the line. Right turn on red OK after a full stop (unless "No Turn on Red").
Flashing RED	Treat exactly like a stop sign - full stop, then go when clear.
RED ARROW	Stop. No turn in that direction until it changes.

4. PAVEMENT MARKINGS

Easy rule: **YELLOW** separates opposite directions. **WHITE** separates same direction.

Line	Meaning
Dashed yellow	Passing allowed if safe
Solid yellow on YOUR side	No passing
Double solid yellow	No passing either direction (may cross only to turn)
Dashed white	Changing lanes is OK
Solid white	Stay in your lane
Center lane, solid + dashed yellow both sides	Shared center left-turn lane (both directions)

- **Reversible lanes:** green arrow = lane open; red **X** = closed; flashing yellow X = move out of it.
- **Reserved lanes:** white diamond = HOV/bus/bike. "HOV 3" = 3+ people required.

5. RIGHT-OF-WAY (who goes first)

Key idea: the law only says who must **YIELD**. It never gives you the right-of-way - you must make sure it's safe.

- **Pedestrians always win** - yield even if they jaywalk.
- **Blind pedestrian** (white cane or guide dog) -> **always stop**. Don't honk (it scares them).
- **Turning left** -> yield to oncoming traffic going straight or turning right.
- **Uncontrolled intersection** (no signs) -> yield to the car **on your right**.
- **4-way stop** -> first to arrive goes. **Tie? The car on the right goes.**
- **Entering from a driveway/alley/private road** -> yield to traffic already on the road.
- **Roundabout/traffic circle** -> yield to traffic **already in the circle** ; go **counterclockwise** ; slow to **15-20 mph** ; don't change lanes or pass; signal right before your exit.
- **Emergency vehicle** (lights/siren) -> pull to the **right and stop** ; stay **500 ft** back.
- **Never enter an intersection** (even on green) unless you can get all the way through.

6. STOPPING & SCHOOL BUSES

Come to a **FULL STOP** for:

- A stop sign, a red light, or a **flashing red** light
- A **school crossing guard** holding a flag
- A flag person at a railroad crossing or construction site
- An emergency vehicle approaching with lights/siren
- Pulling out of an alley/driveway in a business or residential area

School buses:

- **Stop** when a school/church/daycare bus has **red lights flashing** or its **stop arm out** - whether it's on

your side OR the oncoming side of an undivided road (two yellow lines between).

- **Exception:** On a **divided highway**, traffic going the **opposite** direction does **not** stop.
 - Stay stopped until the red lights stop flashing and the stop arm folds in.
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7. SPEED, STOPPING & FOLLOWING DISTANCE

- **Basic Speed Law:** Never drive faster than is reasonable and prudent for conditions - even below the posted limit (rain, fog, traffic). 55 mph in a snowstorm is **not** legal just because it's posted.
- **2-second rule** (good conditions); **add a second** for rain, night, gravel, heavy loads, tailgaters, or following motorcycles/large trucks.
- It's illegal to drive **so slowly** you block traffic; driving **15+ mph slower** than traffic flow is as dangerous as speeding.

Stopping distance (a frequent test topic):

- Total stopping distance = **perception + reaction + braking** distance.
- **Perception time** for an alert driver **3/4 to 1 second**.
- Doubling speed (20->40 mph) makes braking distance **4 longer**; tripling (20->60) makes it **9**; 80 mph **16** the impact of 20 mph.
- At 60 mph it takes about **4-5 seconds** / **~360 feet** to perceive and stop.

Merging / changing lanes: Look for a **4-6 second gap**. Check mirrors **and** your blind spot (over your shoulder) before moving. Use the acceleration lane to match traffic speed; don't stop at its end. Don't cross a solid white line.

8. PASSING

- Pass on the **left**. Signal, make sure it's clear, don't exceed the speed limit.
 - Return only when you see the passed car in your rearview mirror - and **before** you're within **200 feet** of any oncoming car.
 - **Do NOT pass when:**
 - Within **100 feet** of a bridge, tunnel, intersection, or railroad crossing
 - On a hill or curve, or any marked no-passing zone (you can't see **1/3 mile** / **~20-25 sec** ahead)
 - There's a **solid yellow line on your side**
 - Within **100 feet** of a stopped emergency vehicle (lights on)
 - **Passing on the right** is allowed only on one-way streets or multilane roads going the same direction. **Never pass on the shoulder.**
 - If you're **being passed:** keep right, hold a steady speed, don't speed up.
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9. ALCOHOL, DRUGS, DISTRACTION & FITNESS TO DRIVE

- **Illegal at .08 BAC or higher** (adults). **Under 21 = zero tolerance.** Vision is affected at just **.02 BAC**.
- Alcohol/drugs are in about **40% of fatal crashes**.
- **Only time** sobers you up - not coffee, food, or a shower. Body removes **~ one drink per hour**.
- **Implied Consent:** Having a license means you've agreed to a breath/blood/urine test if an officer asks.

Refusing = lose your license 1 year.

- **Prescription and over-the-counter drugs** can impair you like alcohol - check labels.
 - **Texting/writing/reading** on a device while driving is **illegal** in Kansas.
 - **Fatigue:** If tired, pull over for a **15-20 minute nap** - don't "push through."
 - **Cell phone:** best practice is to **stop in a safe spot** to call/text.
 - **Emotions:** Angry or upset? Cool off before driving. **Aggressive driver?** Get out of their way, don't make eye contact, don't challenge them.
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10. SEAT BELTS, AIR BAGS & CHILD SAFETY

- **Seat belts required for ALL occupants** - a **primary violation** (police can stop you just for that).
 - Wear belts **even with air bags** - air bags don't protect in side impacts or rollovers and won't keep you behind the wheel.
 - Shoulder belt across the shoulder/chest (never under the arm or behind the back); lap belt low and snug across the hips.
 - **Under 4** -> child safety seat. **4-8** -> safety/booster seat unless taller than **4'9"** OR over **80 lbs** -> then a seat belt. **8+** -> seat belt.
 - **Children 12 and under** should ride in the **back seat**.
 - **Never** put a **rear-facing infant seat in front of an active airbag**. Keep ~ **10 inches** between your chest and the steering wheel.
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11. PARKING

No parking:

- Within an intersection or crosswalk
- Within **15 feet** of a fire hydrant
- More than **12 inches** from the curb
- In front of a driveway, on a sidewalk, on a bridge, or in a tunnel
- Within **30 feet** of a stop sign, signal, or flashing beacon
- Within **50 feet** of a railroad crossing
- Within **20 feet** of a fire-station driveway (75 ft on the opposite side)
- In a handicapped space without a permit

Parking on a hill (test favorite):

- **Downhill** -> turn wheels **toward** the curb.
- **Uphill WITH a curb** -> turn wheels **away** from the curb.
- **No curb (either way)** -> turn wheels **toward** the shoulder/edge.

(Logic: if your brakes fail, the curb or roadside stops the car instead of rolling into traffic.)

12. SHARING THE ROAD

- **Bicyclists** have the same rights/rules as cars; they ride on the right and use hand signals. Give them

room when passing; don't honk close to them. Watch for **"Dead Red Law"** (a cyclist may cross on a light that won't detect them).

- **Motorcycles/mopeds** get a **full lane**. They're hard to see - check blind spots. Follow at **3-4 seconds**. Don't assume they're turning just because a signal is on (signals may not self-cancel). A **moped** has 3.5 hp and tops out at ~30 mph.
 - **Emergency vehicles** (siren/lights): pull to the **right and stop**. Stay **500 feet** back.
 - **Move-Over Law**: Approaching a stopped emergency/tow vehicle with flashing lights -> move over a lane if you can, or slow down.
 - **Large trucks/buses** have huge blind spots ("**No-Zones**") - front, rear, and both sides. If you can't see the driver's mirror, they can't see you. They swing **wide** for turns - never squeeze between a turning truck and the curb. A loaded truck at 55 mph needs **11/2** a car's stopping distance.
 - **Transit bus**: You do **not** have to stop for a transit bus (unlike a school bus) - but watch for pedestrians around it.
 - **Slow-moving vehicles** (farm equipment, animal-drawn): orange/red triangle = under 25 mph. Pass with caution; they may swing left before a right turn.
 - **Trains**: Never shift gears on the tracks. If you stall on the tracks, get out and **run toward the direction the train is coming from** (debris flies away from you). A 100-car train at 55 mph needs over **a mile** to stop. Always expect a train.
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13. BEFORE YOU DRIVE & BASIC CONTROL

- **Adjust seat and mirrors before driving**. Top of the steering wheel no higher than your shoulders; ~ **10 inches** from your chest to the wheel.
 - **Head restraint** should contact the back of your head (not below your ears) to prevent whiplash.
 - **Steering - preferred method is hand-to-hand (push/pull)**, hands at **9 and 3** (or 8 and 4). The old **10-and-2** is not recommended because of airbags. Use **one hand only** when backing or operating controls.
 - **Backing**: Check behind the vehicle first, go slow, turn and look over your shoulder through the rear window (mirrors don't show directly behind you). It's illegal to back in a travel lane except to parallel park.
 - **Before starting**: make sure the **parking brake is set**, then start. **Before stopping**: check mirrors for traffic.
 - **Traction technology**: **ABS** lets you brake and steer at the same time without skidding - press **firmly and hold** (don't pump). Remember **Search, Stomp, Steer**. **ESP** (stability control) helps prevent skids.
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14. VISUAL SEARCH & COMMUNICATING

- **Scan well ahead** - look **12-15 seconds** down the road (city: ~2 blocks; highway: ~1/4 mile). Keep your eyes moving; check mirrors every few seconds and before any lane change, slow-down, or hill.
- **Headlights**: Turn them on when it gets dark, in rain/snow/fog, and **whenever your wipers are on** (required in Kansas). High beams see twice as far - but **dim** them within ~one block (500 ft) of an oncoming car or when following someone.
- **Horn**: A light tap to warn someone who may not see you. A **sharp blast** only in real danger. Don't use it to greet people, hurry others, or near blind pedestrians/horses.
- **Signaling**: Signal **100 ft** before a turn in town (**200 ft** above 40 mph), or **3-4 seconds** ahead. Cancel it

after the turn.

- **Disabled vehicle:** Get off the road, turn on hazard flashers, raise the hood or tie a white cloth, set flares **200-300 feet** behind.

Driver hand-and-arm signals (use these when your signal/brake lights fail - and a common test topic):

Intention	Left arm out the window
Left turn	Arm straight out, horizontal
Right turn	Arm bent up at the elbow (hand pointing up)
Slow / stop	Arm bent down at the elbow (hand pointing down)

You must also obey a **school crossing guard at all times** while they direct traffic.

15. NIGHT, WEATHER & EMERGENCIES

Night:

- Use **high beams** when no oncoming traffic; **dim** within ~one block. Don't stare into oncoming headlights. **Never wear sunglasses** at night.
- Low beams light ~150-200 ft (safe to ~45 mph); high beams ~350-400 ft (safe to ~65 mph).

Weather & traction:

- Roads are **most slippery when rain/snow/sleet FIRST starts** (water mixes with oil and dirt).
- **Reduce speed and increase following distance** on gravel/dirt, wet, or icy roads. **Bridges and overpasses freeze first.**
- **Hydroplaning** starts around **35 mph** on wet roads (worse with worn tires) - slow down in the rain.
- **Adverse weather:** if you can't see more than **100 feet** , don't go faster than **30 mph** ; pull over if it's too bad.
- **Studded snow tires** are legal **Nov 1 - Apr 1** only.

Skids / losing traction: Look where you want to go, **ease off the pedals**, and steer toward your intended path - don't slam the brakes or oversteer.

Emergencies:

- **Brake failure:** pump the pedal, then use the parking brake gradually, then steer to a safe stop.
- **Tire blowout:** grip the wheel, **don't brake hard**, ease off the gas, let it slow, pull off.
- **Stuck accelerator / power loss:** shift to **neutral** , steer to the side, brake gently.
- **Avoiding a crash:** you can usually **steer** away faster than you can stop. With ABS, brake hard **and** steer.
- **Rollovers:** mostly single-vehicle; caused by speed and oversteering. SUVs/vans/pickups are more prone. **Seat belts** are the best protection.
- **Flooded road: turn around. 6 inches** of water can move a car; **2 feet** can sweep it away.
- **Animals: don't swerve** - brake and stay in your lane. Deer are most active at **dawn/dusk** and **Oct-Dec**.

Seasonal (optional section):

- **Winter:** carry a survival kit; if stranded, **stay with the vehicle** , run the engine ~10 min/hour, keep the

exhaust pipe clear, crack a window.

- **Hot weather:** watch tire pressure, coolant, and "bleeding tar" (slippery).
 - **Tornado:** leave the vehicle for sturdy shelter; **don't hide under an overpass.**
 - **Lightning:** stay inside a hard-topped vehicle with windows up; don't touch metal.
 - **Trip planning:** limit driving to ~ **6-8 hours/day** (one driver); avoid driving after 11 p.m.
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Final Tips for Test Day

- Take the knowledge test **online at ks.knowtodrive.com** or at a license office.
- Read each question fully - wrong answers are often "almost right."
- When unsure, pick the **safest, most cautious** option - it's usually correct.
- Re-read the **1-Page Cheat Sheet** right before you go in.
- Then run the **practice tests** (separate files) until you're scoring **90%+** .

Good luck!